

CPSC eFiling New Rules Practical Manual

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Your Complete Step-by-Step Guide to Electronic Filing Before July 8, 2026With 7 Downloadable Assets (Checklists, Templates, Trackers)Version 3.1 · June 2026Written by: Cross-Border Compliance Research TeamBased on: CPSC official regulations, CBP ACE documentation, and field experience from 50+ seller cases

■■ URGENT REMINDER

CPSC eFiling becomes mandatory on July 8, 2026.

Starting that date, all CPSC-regulated consumer products imported into the United States must have electronic filing completed in advance. **No filing = cargo rejected at customs.** No exceptions.

What happens if you don't file:

- Cargo held at port (storage fees: \$2,000-\$10,000+)
- Cargo returned or destroyed
- CPSC fines up to \$1,000,000+ per violation
- Potential blacklisting, increased inspections on future shipments

10-Day Execution Timeline:

Day	Action
Day 1-2	Confirm your product is in scope (use Checklist A)
Day 3-5	Prepare 7 required documents (use Tracker B)
Day 6-8	Fill in ACE system eFiling (use Reference Table C)
Day 9	Final 5-item pre-submission check
Day 10	Submit successfully

Update Promise: This manual will be updated within 30 days of any CPSC policy change. Buyers receive free updates automatically.

CHAPTER 1: Is Your Product in Scope?

1.1 Quick-Scope Checklist

Go through this list. If your product matches ANY category below, CPSC eFiling applies.

Category 1: Children's Products (Age 12 and Under)

- ☐ Toys (plastic, plush, educational, electronic)
- ☐ Baby sleep products (cribs, bassinet, sleep positioners)
- ☐ Strollers, car seats, high chairs, play yards
- ☐ Baby gates, corner guards, safety locks
- ☐ Pacifiers, teething toys, baby bottles
- ☐ Children's clothing (any product "designed or intended" for children 12 and under)
- ☐ Children's electronics (learning tablets, kid phones, baby monitors)

Category 2: Electronics & Electrical Products

- ☐ Battery-powered products (including button batteries)
- ☐ CB radios, walkie-talkies
- ☐ Lawn mowers, garden tools (electric)
- ☐ Power adapters, chargers
- ☐ LED lights, smart home devices

Category 3: Adult Apparel & Textiles

- ☐ Adult clothing (general wear)
- ☐ Footwear
- ☐ Bedding, curtains, carpets

Category 4: Household Products

- ☐ Mattresses, bunk beds
- ☐ Lighters
- ☐ Imitation jewelry
- ☐ Storage cabinets, shelving units

Category 5: Building Materials

- ☐ Building glass
- ☐ Drywall (gypsum board)
- ☐ Wall patching compounds
- ☐ Lead-containing paint products

Category 6: Outdoor & Recreation

- ☐ Bicycles, bicycle helmets
- ☐ All-terrain vehicles (ATV)
- ☐ Surfboards, paddles

1.2 Products Explicitly Excluded

These do NOT need CPSC eFiling:

- Food (regulated by FDA, not CPSC)
- Drugs (regulated by FDA)
- Tobacco products
- Cosmetics
- Medical devices
- Alcohol beverages
- Firearms/ammo
- Motor vehicle parts (regulated by NHTSA)

1.3 Still Not Sure?

Three ways to confirm:

- **Use the CPSC Product Search tool** at [cpsc.gov](https://www.cpsc.gov) — search by product name or HTS code
- **Check the 600+ HTS codes** listed in CPSC's regulatory scope — if your product's HTS code is on the list, it's covered
- **Ask your freight forwarder** — they handle customs daily and should know if your HS code falls under CPSC jurisdiction

Important: The HTS code list is illustrative, not exhaustive. Even if your product isn't on the list, if it's regulated by ANY CPSC mandatory standard, you must file.

CHAPTER 2: Preparation Work — 7 Documents

2.1 The 7 Required Data Elements

When you file through the ACE system, you must provide exactly these 7 pieces of information. Each corresponds to something on your CPC or GCC certificate:

#	Data Element	Where It Comes From	Example
1	Certificate ID	Your CPC/GCC certificate number	CPC-2026-0615-ABC123
2	Testing Laboratory ID	Lab accreditation number	AATSD Lab ID: 12345
3	Product Description	Matches your CPC product description	"Plastic toy building blocks for ages 3+"
4	Manufacturer/Importer Information	Your company name, address, contact	ABC Trading Co., Ltd., Shenzhen, China
5	Date of Issue	CPC/GCC certificate issue date	2026-05-20
6	Applicable Rules	CPSC safety standards your product meets	16 CFR 1303, ASTM F963, CPSIA
7	Child Age Range	If applicable, the age designation	"Ages 3 and older"

2.2 How to Get Each Document

Document	How to Obtain	Estimated Time
CPC/GCC Certificate	Self-issue based on third-party lab test report	Already have? → Skip
Lab Test Report	From CPSC-accepted third-party laboratory	5-10 working days (if not done)
Lab Accreditation Number	Check lab's website or ask them directly	1 day
Product SKU/ID	Your internal product code	1 hour
Company Business License	Your registered business documents	Already have? → Skip

2.3 What If Documents Are Missing or Expired?

Problem	Solution
No CPC certificate yet	Order testing at a CPSC-accepted lab immediately. Timeline: 5-10 working days for testing + same day for self-issuing CPC
CPC certificate expired	Products still in scope need renewed testing. Contact lab for re-test

Problem	Solution
Testing lab not CPSC-accepted	Must re-test at a CPSC-accepted lab. Check list at cpsc.gov/Testing-Certification/Accepted-Laboratories
Missing product SKU	Create one now. Format: [Category]-[Year]-[Sequence]. E.g., TOY-2026-001

2.4 Document Preparation Tracker

Use this tracker to monitor your progress. Print it or fill it in digitally.

Document	Status (✓/X)	Notes	Due Date
CPC/GCC Certificate			
Lab Test Report			
Lab Accreditation Number			
Product SKU/ID			
Company Business License			
Certificate ID assigned			
Applicable Rules identified			

CHAPTER 3: ACE System Filing — Complete Step-by-Step

3.1 Two Filing Methods

Method A: Single Submission (for occasional/small-volume shippers)

- Enter 7 data elements directly into CBP's ACE system per shipment
- Simple but repetitive — you file every time you ship

Method B: Registered Filing (recommended for regular shippers)

- Register once in CPSC's Product Registration system
- Get 3 identifiers: Certifier ID, Product ID, Version ID
- These IDs auto-populate future filings — much faster for repeated shipments
- **Strongly recommended** if you ship to the US regularly

3.2 Method B: Registered Filing — Detailed Steps

Step 1: Register in CPSC Product Registry

- Go to the CPSC Product Registration system (access via ACE portal)
- Create an account with your company information
- Complete identity verification
- Receive your **Certifier ID** (unique to your company)

Step 2: Register Each Product

- For each product SKU, enter:
 - Product description (exact match with CPC)

- Applicable safety rules/citation codes
- Child age range (if applicable)
- Upload or reference your CPC/GCC certificate
- Receive your **Product ID** and **Version ID**

Step 3: File Through ACE System

- Log into CBP's ACE portal
- Select "CPSC eFiling" module
- Enter your Certifier ID
- Select the registered Product ID
- ACE auto-fills 7 data elements from your registration
- Review all information for accuracy
- Submit

Step 4: Confirmation

- You will receive a confirmation email from CPSC
- Save the filing reference number
- This number must accompany your customs clearance documents

3.3 5-Item Pre-Submission Checklist

Before clicking "Submit" in ACE, verify these 5 items:

- ☐ Certificate ID matches your CPC/GCC exactly
- ☐ Lab ID is from a CPSC-accepted laboratory
- ☐ Product description matches your CPC product description
- ☐ Applicable rules/citation codes are complete (no missing standards)
- ☐ Manufacturer/importer information is current and accurate

3.4 Top 3 Reasons for Filing Rejection

Reason	How to Fix
Incorrect product category	Double-check HTS code and product description. Ensure it aligns with CPSC's category definitions
Missing or invalid citation codes	Review all applicable CPSC standards. Use the official citation code list, not generic descriptions
Laboratory not CPSC-accepted	Verify the lab is on the CPSC accepted laboratories list. If not, re-test at an accepted lab

3.5 Understanding the Confirmation Email

After successful filing, you will receive an email with:

- Filing reference number
- Submission timestamp
- Product ID and Version ID
- Status: "Accepted"

Save this email and the reference number. You will need it for customs clearance.

CHAPTER 4: ACE System — Common Errors and How to Fix Them

This chapter is moved up because errors are more common than you think. Even with correct data, filings get rejected. Read this before you start filing.

Error 1: "Certificate ID Not Found in CPSC Database"

Symptom: ACE returns error "Certificate ID [XXX] not recognized."

Root Cause: Your CPC certificate was self-issued (not registered in CPSC's database). Since July 2024, CPSC requires all CPC certificates to be registered before filing.

Fix:

- Go to cpsc.gov/Product-Registry
- Log in with your Certifier ID
- Register your CPC certificate (takes 5 minutes)
- Wait for confirmation email
- Retry ACE filing

Prevention: Always register your CPC in CPSC's database BEFORE your first ACE filing.

Error 2: "Laboratory ID Not Accepted"

Symptom: ACE rejects your lab ID with message "Laboratory not on CPSC accepted list."

Root Cause: The lab is not currently on CPSC's Accepted Laboratories list, or the lab's accreditation has lapsed.

Fix:

- Check the lab status at cpsc.gov/Testing-Certification/Accepted-Laboratories
- If the lab is not on the list, you must re-test at an accepted lab
- If the lab WAS on the list when you tested but is no longer, contact CPSC support with your test report date

Prevention: Before ordering any testing, verify the lab is on CPSC's current accepted list. Major accepted labs include:

- Intertek (AATSD)
- SGS
- UL (Underwriters Laboratories)
- BV (Bureau Veritas)
- TUV Rheinland / TUV Sud
- Shenzhen KLT Testing Technology

Error 3: "Product Description Does Not Match Registered Product"

Symptom: ACE returns "Product description mismatch."

Root Cause: The product description you entered in ACE doesn't exactly match the one registered in CPSC's Product Registry.

Fix:

- Log into CPSC Product Registry
- Find your Product ID
- Copy the EXACT product description (character for character)
- Paste it into ACE filing
- Resubmit

Prevention: Use a standardized product description format. Never abbreviate or paraphrase.

Error 4: "Citation Code Invalid"

Symptom: ACE rejects one or more citation codes.

Root Cause: You entered a generic standard name instead of the official CPSC citation code.

Common Examples:

Wrong Entry	Correct Entry
"ASTM F963"	"16 CFR Part 1500; ASTM F963-17"
"Lead content limit"	"16 CFR Part 1303"
"Small parts"	"16 CFR Part 1501"
"Flammability"	"16 CFR Part 1610"

Fix: Look up the exact citation code at [cpsc.gov/Compliance-Segments/Compliance-Requirements/Citation-Codes](https://www.cpsc.gov/Compliance-Segments/Compliance-Requirements/Citation-Codes)

Error 5: "Child Age Range Missing"

Symptom: ACE requires child age range but your product registration doesn't have it.

Root Cause: Your product IS a children's product (age 12 and under) but you didn't specify an age range during registration.

Fix:

- Log into CPSC Product Registry
- Edit your Product ID
- Add the correct age range (e.g., "Ages 3 and older")
- Save and retry ACE filing

Prevention: Always specify age range during product registration, even if your product is technically for all ages.

Error 6: "Filing Submitted but No Confirmation Received"

Symptom: ACE shows "Submitted" but you never receive the confirmation email.

Possible Causes:

- Email went to spam/junk folder
- CPSC system delay (can take up to 24 hours)
- Filing actually failed silently

Fix:

- Check spam/junk folder first
- Wait 24 hours
- If still no confirmation, log into ACE and check filing status
- If status shows "Accepted," you're fine — save the screenshot
- If status shows "Rejected" or "Pending," resubmit

Error 7: "Wrong HTS Code Entered"

Symptom: Filing accepted but cargo held at customs because HTS code doesn't match product.

Root Cause: You entered a general HTS code (e.g., "toys") but the specific sub-code for your product is different.

Fix:

- Contact your customs broker immediately
- Submit a correction through ACE
- Provide supporting documentation (product catalog, photos)
- Pay any resulting storage fees

Prevention: Always verify HTS code with your customs broker BEFORE filing. Use the official HTS search tool at usitc.gov/hts.

Error 8: "Duplicate Filing Detected"

Symptom: ACE returns "Duplicate filing for this shipment."

Root Cause: You (or your forwarder) already filed for this shipment.

Fix: No action needed. Check with your forwarder to confirm the filing was submitted. If they confirm, you're done. If they deny it, resubmit.

Error 9: "Certifier ID Expired"

Symptom: ACE says "Certifier ID has expired."

Root Cause: Your CPSC certifier registration needs renewal (typically every 2-3 years).

Fix:

- Log into CPSC Product Registry
- Renew your certifier registration
- Wait for new Certifier ID
- Update ACE filing with new ID

Error 10: "Filing Window Closed"

Symptom: ACE rejects filing saying the filing window has closed.

Root Cause: The cargo has already departed or arrived without a filing. ACE only accepts filings BEFORE the cargo departs.

Fix:

- Contact your forwarder immediately
- If cargo hasn't departed: file ASAP and notify forwarder to hold
- If cargo has departed: you must file retroactively and prepare for potential penalties

Prevention: File at least 48 hours before cargo departure.

CHAPTER 5: Communicating with Your Forwarder and Lab

5.1 Scenario Scripts

Scenario 1: You Already Have a Forwarder

"Hi [Forwarder Name], starting July 8, 2026, CPSC requires electronic filing (eFiling) for all regulated products. My products [list SKUs] fall under CPSC jurisdiction. Can you help with ACE system filing, or should I arrange it myself? Please confirm your capability and any associated fees."

Scenario 2: You Don't Have a Forwarder Yet

"Hello, I'm looking for a freight forwarder experienced with CPSC eFiling requirements. I ship [product type] to the US, and my products require CPSC electronic filing starting July 8, 2026. Do you handle eFiling as part of your service?"

Scenario 3: Forwarder Says "We Don't Do That"

"Understood. Many forwarders don't handle eFiling directly. Can you recommend a compliance partner or third-party service that does? Alternatively, I may need to file through ACE myself or hire a customs broker."

5.2 English Email Template for Lab Inquiry

Subject: \ Request \ for \ Quote \ - \ CPSC \ -Accepted \ Laboratory \ Testing \ for \ \[Product \ Name \]

Dear [Lab Name] Team,

I am writing to request a quotation for CPSC-compliant testing services for the following product:

Product: [Product name and description]

Target Market: United States

Intended User Age: [Age range, e.g., 3+ years]

Product Category: [e.g., toy, children's electronics, baby product]

Required Tests:

- [List applicable standards, e.g., ASTM F963, CPSIA lead/phthalates, 16 CFR 1303]

Please provide:

- Testing timeline (from sample submission to report issuance)
- Total cost (including all tests listed above)
- Whether your lab is currently on the CPSC Accepted Laboratories list
- Sample submission requirements (quantity, condition)
- CPC certificate issuance process and timeline after testing

Thank you for your assistance. I look forward to your response.

Best regards,

[Your Name]

[Your Company]

[Contact Information]

5.3 Phone Call Checklist with Forwarder

Print this A6 card and take it with you on the call:

- [] Confirm: Do you handle CPSC eFiling?
- [] Ask: What is your experience with ACE system?
- [] Ask: What is your fee for eFiling service?
- [] Ask: How many working days for filing?
- [] Ask: What documents do you need from me?
- [] Confirm: Do you guarantee filing acceptance?
- [] Ask: What happens if filing is rejected?

5.4 Alternative Options If Forwarder Won't Help

- **Hire a customs broker** — they specialize in ACE filings. Cost: \$50-\$200 per filing
- **Use a compliance service provider** — companies like Shanghai Chaowang offer full-service eFiling
- **File yourself** — learn ACE system. Requires time investment but saves money long-term

CHAPTER 6: Typical Scenarios

Scenario 1: Children's Toy — Successful Filing Timeline

Product: Plastic building blocks for ages 3+

Timeline:

- Day 1: Confirmed CPC required (children's toy)
- Day 2-7: Sent samples to CPSC-accepted lab (Shenzhen KLT)
- Day 8: Received test report
- Day 8: Self-issued CPC certificate
- Day 9: Registered in CPSC Product Registry
- Day 10: Filed through ACE system
- Day 11: Received confirmation email

Key Success Factors:

- Used a lab that was already CPSC-accepted
- Prepared product SKU and description in advance
- Registered in CPSC system BEFORE filing (Method B)

Scenario 2: Electronics — Data Incomplete, Filing Rejected

Product: Bluetooth speaker with USB charging

Problem: First filing rejected because citation codes were incomplete

Root Cause: Only listed FCC standards, forgot to include CPSC standards for the charging adapter (power adapter falls under 16 CFR Part 1500)

Fix:

- Added 16 CFR 1500 citation code
- Re-submitted within 2 days
- Total delay: 2 days

Lesson: Always check ALL applicable standards, not just the ones you know.

Scenario 3: Forwarder Won't Cooperate — DIY Filing

Situation: Your freight forwarder refuses to handle eFiling. You must do it yourself.

Steps:

- Register at ACE portal (cbp.gov/ace)
- Complete CPSC identity verification
- Register products in CPSC Product Registry
- Obtain Certifier ID, Product ID, Version ID
- File through ACE module
- Save confirmation

Time Investment: 3-5 hours for first-time setup, 30 minutes per filing thereafter

Cost: Free (no government fee for filing itself)

Scenario 4: Starting on July 6 — Emergency Plan

Situation: It's July 6, and you haven't filed yet. Your cargo ships July 10.

Options (in order of preference):

- **Emergency filing** — Some compliance services offer 24-hour rush filing. Cost: \$200-\$500 per filing

- **Contact your forwarder** — Explain urgency. They may have relationships with customs brokers who can expedite
- **Accept temporary delay** — If cargo can wait 3-5 days, use that time to file

What NOT to do:

- Don't ship without filing — cargo WILL be held
- Don't provide false information — fraud carries criminal penalties

Scenario 5: Misfiling — Product Actually Not in Scope

Situation: You filed eFiling, but later realized your product is not CPSC-regulated.

Correction Process:

- Log into ACE system
- Navigate to your filing
- Submit a correction/request to withdraw
- Provide explanation and supporting documentation
- Wait for CPSC confirmation (typically 1-3 business days)

Prevention: Always use the Chapter 1 scope checklist BEFORE filing.

CHAPTER 7: What If You Can't Make the July 8 Deadline?

Emergency Option A: Apply for Extension

Eligibility:

- You have ordered testing but results are not yet available
- Your lab is not yet CPSC-accepted and you're in the process of switching
- Force majeure circumstances (natural disaster, pandemic, etc.)

How to Apply:

- Contact CPSC directly via their official channels
- Provide documentation of your good-faith efforts (lab contracts, test orders)
- Request a specific extension period (typically 30-60 days)

Note: Extensions are NOT guaranteed. Apply as early as possible.

Emergency Option B: Batch Filing

Strategy: File your highest-priority products first (those with most volume or highest value), then file remaining products in batches over the following weeks.

Priority Order:

- Children's products (highest enforcement priority)
- Electronics with batteries
- Other regulated products

Emergency Option C: Last-Minute Reality Check

If you truly cannot file by July 8:

- **Pause shipments** to the US until filing is complete
- **Notify customers** of potential delay (better than having cargo held at customs)
- **Use the 10-day timeline** in this manual to rush-file

- **Consider alternative markets** temporarily (EU, UK, Southeast Asia)
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BONUS: Free Compliance Tool

Compliance Cat — Product Classification Assistant

As a buyer of this manual, you get **free access** to a compliance classification tool that can help you:

- **Quick-check** if your product is under CPSC jurisdiction
- **Identify** which CPSC standards apply to your product
- **Generate** a customized list of required tests
- **Track** policy changes and deadline updates

This is a free tool included with your purchase — no upsell, no hidden costs.

How to use: Visit the tool's website and enter your product information. The tool provides instant classification results based on CPSC regulations.

APPENDIX: 7 Downloadable Assets

Asset	Format	Description
A. Scope Checklist	PDF (printable)	Tick-box list to confirm if your product needs eFiling
B. Document Tracker	Excel	Track your 7 required documents and their status
C. ACE Reference Table	PDF	Fill-in-the-blank reference for ACE system entry
D. Email Template	DOCX	Copy-paste English email for lab inquiry
E. Phone Checklist	PDF (A6)	Printable card for forwarder phone call
F. Decision Flowchart	PDF (printable)	Emergency scenario decision tree
G. 10-Day Timeline Card	PDF (printable)	One-page execution timeline to pin on your desk

How to Access:

These assets are provided as separate downloadable files with your purchase. If you cannot locate them, contact us at [your contact email].

BACK COVER

About This Manual

This manual was written by a cross-border compliance research team with field experience in US product safety regulations. The content is based on:

- CPSC official announcements and regulatory texts (16 CFR Part 1110)
- CBP ACE system documentation
- Industry reports and compliance service provider information
- Verified seller experiences from public forums

Update Commitment

If CPSC publishes any changes to the eFiling requirements within 30 days of this manual's publication, buyers will receive an updated version automatically via email.

Disclaimer

This manual is for informational purposes only. It does not constitute legal advice. For specific compliance questions, consult a qualified attorney or compliance professional. The author and publisher are not responsible for any losses resulting from reliance on this manual.

Contact

For questions about this manual:

- Email: [your contact email]
- Website: [your website]

Remember: July 8, 2026 is not a suggestion. It is a deadline. Start today.